was gaining momentum. While the Indian population had failed to rise up with the outbreak of the Afghan War, this was not to say that it might not do so should the conflict continue. In 1919, the viceroy's entire attention was therefore needed at home. While Montagu was admonishing the Indian government to remember that 'we, and not he [the emir], are the victors',[154] Chelmsford appeared more realistic about India's current weaknesses. His aim in the peace negotiations was to deal firmly and resolutely with the emir in order to bring about a peaceful resolution as quickly as possible and in such a way as to maintain a strong yet friendly Afghanistan and prevent it from becoming a hostile centre of pan-Islamic and Bolshevik propaganda.[155]

Indeed, the Anglo-Afghan peace negotiations and the treaty that would eventually be proposed were designed to achieve a quick resolution to the conflict by creating a temporary basis for a firm peace: in Chelmsford's words, 'first peace, then friendship'.[156] The biggest issue, nevertheless, would prove the hardest for the Indian government to try to postpone, for it soon became clear that the Afghan delegation would refuse to come to any agreement that allowed for Britain's continued control over their country's external relations. Chelmsford tried to convince Montagu of the impracticability of insisting on retaining the right to conduct Afghan foreign affairs:

During the past year there has been a profound change in political outlook in [the] middle East, including Afghanistan. General unrest awakened national aspirations, President Wilson's pronouncement, Bolshevik catchwords and other influences have been at work. This change of outlook is evidenced in Amanulla's first utterances as Amir, basis of which was the sovereign independence of Afghanistan, and the complete freedom of his external relations.[157]

It is this recognition of the changing times that set Indian government opinion apart from much of the foreign policy-making elite in London. Afghan intellectuals such as Tarzi had done much over the last few years to